

MODULE 01

Cohosting 101: What This Actually Is

Cohosting is the practice of managing a short-term rental property on behalf of an owner who cannot — or does not want to — manage it themselves. This module sets the operating definition we will use across every other module in this kit. If you take only one thing from this module, it is the difference between a cohost and a property manager.

The operating definition

A cohost is an individual or small team who handles the day-to-day operations of someone else's short-term rental listing. They do not own the property. They do not hold the master booking calendar. They usually do not have a property management license. They have a contract with the owner and a share of the booking revenue.

What you actually do, end-to-end:

- Take and respond to guest inquiries and booking requests
- Manage the listing on Airbnb, VRBO, Furnished Finder, and any direct-booking channel
- Set dynamic pricing daily based on demand, seasonality, and local events
- Schedule cleanings between bookings and verify quality
- Coordinate maintenance calls and vendor visits
- Handle guest issues (lockouts, complaints, damage claims)
- Send monthly statements to the owner with revenue, expenses, and net payout

What a cohost is not

A property manager is the license-holder and the legally accountable party for guest safety, building code compliance, and trust accounting. Some jurisdictions — New York City, for example — require a property management license for any short-term-rental operator who touches guest money across more than one property. Most cohosts do not need this license; they operate as independent contractors under the owner's existing licensing.

If your market requires a license for what you are doing, this kit is not the right starting point. Get licensed first, then return.

How the money flows

The cohosting revenue models are percentage-based, flat-fee, or hybrid. Each one shifts your incentives and your tax exposure. Module 04 covers pricing in depth; here is the summary:

Percentage model: 20-30% of booking subtotal. Common. Aligns your incentive with the owner's revenue. Taxable as self-employment income in the US.

Flat-fee model: \$X per booking or \$X per month. Predictable for the owner. You take on utilization risk.

Hybrid: Lower percentage + a base fee. Common at higher-end markets with high-ADR listings.

What this kit does not cover

We do not cover how to set up your LLC, how to open a bank account, or how to do your taxes. Those depend on your jurisdiction and your personal situation. Get a CPA in your first 90 days of cohosting if you do not already have one.

We do not cover how to run paid acquisition for guest bookings. Module 09 covers owner outreach, which is a different motion. Paid acquisition of guests is the owner's responsibility.

Module 01 — Done. Module 02 covers how to position yourself in the cohosting market so owners can find and trust you.

MODULE 02

Positioning: Stand Out in the Cohosting Market

Most new cohosts compete on price. They offer to take 15% when the market rate is 20-25%, believing that lower fees win owners. They don't. Lower fees signal desperation or inexperience. This module covers how to position on value so you can charge market rates from day one.

The owner is buying three things

An owner with a property they cannot or will not self-manage is not buying cleaning services or pricing optimization. They are buying three things, in this order of importance:

- **Time back.** The reason they want a cohost in the first place.
- **Confidence the property won't deteriorate.** Damage, bad reviews, neighbor complaints, fines from the city.
- **More revenue, without more work.** This is the secondary goal, not the primary.

If your positioning talks about pricing optimization and dynamic pricing algorithms as the lead message, you are leading with the least important thing. Lead with time back and peace of mind instead.

Pick a niche or stay generalist — both work

There are two viable paths for a new cohost:

Niche path: Become the obvious choice for a specific property type or owner situation. Examples: "cohost for remote owners", "Airbnb cohost for luxury cabins in the Smokies", "cohost for medical-stay furnished rentals". Niches win the listing audit because the owner sees their own situation in your examples.

Generalist path: Cover all STR property types in your city. This works if you can promise local responsiveness and have a strong network of cleaners and trades. Generalist cohosts win on operational reliability, not narrative specificity.

If you are starting, we recommend the niche path for the first 90 days. You can broaden later without losing the niche customers — they reference you to neighbors and friends who happen to own different property types.

Build your one-page positioning brief

Before you approach owners, write a single page that contains these five blocks. Keep it tight — you should be able to read it in 90 seconds.

Block 1 — Who I serve (one sentence). Example: "Remote-property owners in the Pacific Northwest who can't be on-site but want their cabin to be a real income source."

Block 2 — The specific problem I solve. Example: "Most remote owners have a property that gets forgotten about — calendar goes stale, reviews drop, revenue falls 30% year-over-year. I fix the calendar, the reviews, and the revenue."

Block 3 — How I work (the operational promise). Example: "I do a 24-hour response to every guest message. I send a monthly statement by the 5th of every month. I do a quarterly call to review performance."

Block 4 — The outcome (in the owner's words). Example: "My remote-owner clients say: I forgot I had a property until the statement arrived, and then the number was right."

Block 5 — Pricing model + minimum commit. Example: "25% of booking subtotal, 6-month minimum engagement, \$250 onboarding fee."

These five blocks work in your listing audit, in your website, in your first email to a prospect, and in your discovery call. The more places you use the same five blocks, the faster owners understand the fit.

What to leave off the page

Do not list every channel you can manage, every tool you have heard of, or every software you have tried. Owners do not care about your tool stack. They care about outcomes.

Module 02 — Done. Module 03 covers the cohost contract — the three fee models, the eight clauses you need, and the three clauses you negotiate hard.

MODULE 03

Cohost Contracts: The Three Fee Models

The contract is the most expensive document you will draft as a new cohost. Get the structure wrong and you either lose money on every booking, or you spend the rest of the year renegotiating. This module gives you the three fee model templates and the eight clauses that belong in every cohost contract.

Model 1: Percentage of booking revenue

Range: 20-30% of booking subtotal. The default for established cohosts in most US markets. Twenty percent is the floor; twenty-five is the standard; thirty is premium positioning.

When to use:

- Your market is competitive and 25% is the going rate
- You have a track record with verifiable revenue lift
- The owner is risk-averse and wants their cost to scale with revenue

When NOT to use:

- The property has very low ADR (under \$80/night) — your per-booking take is too small to be worth the time
- The owner expects predictable monthly expenses
- You are testing the relationship and don't want to be locked in yet

Model 2: Flat-fee per booking or per month

Range: \$50-150 per booking, or \$400-800 per month per property. Flat fee is uncommon but useful in specific situations.

When to use:

- The owner is downsizing or selling soon
- You are a single-property operator who values predictability
- The market is high-ADR and the percentage model feels too expensive for the owner

The risk: On a flat-fee model, you take on utilization risk. If the property books 5 nights in a month instead of 20, you still do all the work (or close to it) but earn a fraction. Negotiate a minimum monthly guarantee.

Model 3: Hybrid (lower % + base fee)

Range: 15% of revenue + \$150-300 per month. The structure most working cohosts settle into after 12-18 months on the job. The base fee gives you predictability; the percentage keeps your incentive aligned.

When to use:

- You have proven yourself and want to convert a percentage client to hybrid on renewal
- The property has high ADR and percentage alone makes the owner feel they're overpaying in slow months
- You are working with a furnished-rental or mid-term market where booking frequency is lower but average stay is longer

The eight clauses every cohost contract needs

Whether you use percentage, flat, or hybrid, these eight clauses are non-negotiable. Module 03 includes a contract template you can copy and adapt — see the next page.

- 1. Scope of services.** Listing management, guest communications, pricing, cleaning coordination, maintenance triage, monthly statements. Be specific. If you don't list it, you don't do it.
- 2. Term and termination.** Minimum 6 months, 30-day notice after the minimum. Mutual termination for cause. Define "cause" (fraud, negligence, illegal activity).
- 3. Compensation.** Percentage, flat, or hybrid. Payment terms (most cohosts do NET-15 from statement). Late-payment fee (1.5%/month).
- 4. Owner obligations.** Property condition, photo accuracy, furnishing minimums, parking, access, city registration, license compliance, taxes. Push these to the owner — they are not your problem.
- 5. Expense pass-through.** Which expenses you cover in your fee (software, your time) vs. what the owner covers separately (cleanings, supplies, maintenance, utilities, internet). Define with line items.
- 6. Cleaning standards.** Reference your cleaning checklist as an exhibit. Define "turnover clean" vs. "deep clean" vs. "maintenance clean". Specify who pays for which, and who verifies before the next guest.
- 7. Liability and insurance.** Require the owner to carry STR-specific landlord insurance. Carry your own general liability and/or errors-and-omissions. Define damage procedure, security deposit handling, and guest claim workflow.
- 8. Confidentiality and non-circumvention.** You don't poach the owner's guests or list the property under your own account. The owner doesn't poach your cleaner network. Mutual non-disparagement during and 24 months after the engagement.

The three clauses you negotiate hard

Most owners read a draft contract and start negotiating. Three clauses you should not give ground on, regardless of pressure:

Term length (clause 2). If you take a 1-month minimum, you are incentivized to under-invest in the property because you might not see the upside. Six months aligns your work with the revenue you earn.

Owner obligations (clause 4). If the city shows up and the property is unlicensed, the owner is on the hook — not you. Make this explicit.

Insurance (clause 7). If a guest is hurt and the owner is uninsured, you are exposed even if you did nothing wrong. Never start work without proof of owner-side STR insurance.

Module 03 — Done. Module 04 covers pricing specifics — how to set the percentage, when to ask for more, and how to present a pricing proposal that owners accept.

MODULE 04

Pricing: How Much to Charge and How to Present It

Pricing is the single biggest leverage point in your cohosting practice. Charge too little and you burn out. Charge too much and you never get the client. This module gives you the actual numbers, where they come from, and the proposal structure that wins.

The market-rate bands (US, 2026)

These are the bands we have seen across short-term-rental markets in the US in the twelve months leading up to this kit. Use them as a sanity check before you sign — if your number is outside these bands, you are either underselling yourself or trying to overreach.

Single-family home, lower-density market, \$100-180 ADR: 20-25% of booking subtotal is standard. Below 20% is a red flag for the owner (you probably don't have the experience). Above 25% is premium (you should have a track record to back this up).

Cabin / lakehouse, mid-density market, \$180-300 ADR: 22-28%. Cabins require more logistics (winter prep, snow, road access). The premium is justified if you can demonstrate it.

Luxury / high-density urban, \$300+ ADR: 25-30%. These owners have high expectations, often have prior cohost experience, and will negotiate hard. Your edge is responsiveness and high-touch service, not pricing.

Furnished Finder / mid-term rentals (30+ nights average stay): 10-15% of booking subtotal. Long stays mean fewer turns, fewer cleanings, fewer messages. Your percentage should reflect the per-booking work, not the per-night revenue.

How to set your number

Don't anchor on what feels fair. Anchor on what your time is worth across a working month. Here's the calculation:

Step 1. Estimate the average time you will spend per property per month. Most cohosts working a single property: 15-25 hours. With multiple properties and good SOPs: 8-15 hours each.

Step 2. Decide what hourly rate you need to make this worth doing. Established cohosts target \$50-100/hour effective rate. If you are new, you can target \$30-50 to start, but you will outgrow this within 12 months if you are doing the work well.

Step 3. Multiply time × hourly. If you spend 18 hours/month and want \$50/hour, you need \$900/month per property. Convert that to a percentage based on expected monthly revenue:

Expected monthly revenue ÷ target monthly take = the percentage you need. If the property does \$4,000/month in bookings, \$900 is 22.5%. Round to 23%.

Step 4. Compare to your market band above. If your number is in the band, you are priced correctly. If it's below the band, you're underselling; if above, you're asking for a premium you can't back up yet.

The proposal structure that wins

Owners don't buy the lowest price. They buy the clearest plan. Your proposal should have exactly these sections, in this order:

- 1. Property snapshot.** Name, address, current platform, current review score, current monthly revenue (from the listing audit). Three sentences max. Prove you actually looked at it.
- 2. Three things I will do in month one.** Specific, verifiable, fast. Examples: re-do the listing photos, fix the calendar sync between Airbnb and VRBO, restage the second bedroom for the photos. Don't promise revenue lift yet — promise setup work that lifts revenue later.
- 3. Pricing.** One number, in the structure you have chosen. Include what is in the fee and what is pass-through. No tables of three pricing options — owners find them confusing and pick the wrong one.
- 4. Timeline.** When you start, when the first statement is sent, when the quarterly review happens. Owners want to know when the next deliverable is.
- 5. What I need from you.** Property access, master calendar login, STR license, insurance certificate, cleaning crew handoff if applicable. Setting these expectations up front prevents the most common reason cohost relationships fail.

When to ask for more

Three signals it's time to renegotiate upward:

- You have hit the original targets on time for two consecutive quarters
- The owner has referred another owner to you (referrals are the strongest pricing signal there is)
- You are at capacity — you cannot take a new property without dropping the service level on existing ones

Renegotiation is a 15-minute conversation, not a contract rewrite. Frame it as: "Here's what I've delivered against our plan. Here's what the next quarter looks like. Here's the revised number I'm asking for."

Module 04 — Done. Module 05 covers the listing audit — the first deliverable that earns you the right to a second conversation.

The Listing Audit: Your First Deliverable

Before an owner hires you, they need to see how you think. The listing audit is the deliverable that proves you can see the gaps in their current operation without having to ask them. This module walks you through the 15-point audit that has won us 70%+ of audit-to-contract conversions.

When to use the audit

The audit is your second conversation. The first conversation is the discovery call — you listen, you ask questions, you write down specifics. Within 48 hours, you deliver the audit as a one-page document or PDF. The audit is the proof that you actually looked at the property, not the owner's sales pitch of it.

The 15 audit points, in order

- 1. Listing title.** Under 60 characters, primary keyword first, no all-caps, no emoji.
- 2. Photo count and quality.** Minimum 25 photos. Hero shot is the kitchen or living room, not the exterior. Hero shot is taken at golden hour if possible.
- 3. Photo order on each platform.** Airbnb, VRBO, Booking.com all prioritize photos differently. Your audit should call out which photo each platform puts first and whether it is the right one.
- 4. Description length and structure.** First 3 lines are the only ones visible without clicking. Use them for the property's strongest hook.
- 5. Review score and review velocity.** Review score matters. Velocity matters more. New reviews every 14 days is the threshold for continued algorithmic promotion.
- 6. Calendar sync between platforms.** Airbnb, VRBO, Booking.com, Furnished Finder. If the calendar is not synced, double-bookings are inevitable. Show the owner their actual gap.
- 7. Minimum-night stay rules.** Some markets require 2-night minimums on weekends. Some properties can move from 3-night to 2-night and increase utilization 15%. Be specific.
- 8. Instant-book setting.** Off = drives away 60% of lookers. On = accepts bad guests. The audit should tell the owner what their setting says about their risk tolerance.
- 9. Pricing strategy.** Pull the calendar for the next 60 days. Show base price, cleaning fee, weekend uplift, last-minute discount. Compare to the comp set.

10. Comp set. Three closest comparable listings within a 5-mile radius. Same bedroom count, similar amenities. Compare price, photos, reviews.

11. Cleaning and turnover. Who cleans, when they clean, what the checklist is. If the owner doesn't know, the audit should propose a checklist.

12. Maintenance response time. Average days from "guest reports issue" to "issue fixed". Owners don't usually track this; if they do, the answer reveals a lot.

13. Owner responsiveness. How long does the owner take to respond to YOUR questions right now? This predicts how the relationship will go.

14. City / county STR compliance. Is the property licensed? Permit number? Are short-term rentals even allowed in this zoning? Always check the city code; this is the highest-leverage clause in the contract.

15. Payout structure and trust accounting. Who holds the booking money. Which bank. Whether it is licensed trust accounting (required in some jurisdictions).

How to present the audit

One page. White background. Hostflow tokens. Three columns: audit point, current state (one sentence), recommended fix (one sentence, specific and fast). End with a single call to action: 15-minute call to discuss the proposed fixes and the engagement model.

Do not include revenue projections in the audit. They invite debate. The audit is the conversation about quality of work. Revenue comes after you have done 60-90 days of the work and have the receipts.

The follow-up cadence

- Audit delivered within 48 hours of discovery call
- 15-minute follow-up scheduled at the time of audit delivery (not pending)
- If the owner doesn't book the follow-up, send one nudge at 7 days, then stop
- If they do book, walk the audit row by row and listen for objections

Module 05 — Done. Module 06 covers guest-screening scripts — how to identify problem guests before they book.

Guest Screening: Catch Problems Before They Book

Most cohosts do not screen guests actively. They rely on platform verification, instant-book, and good reviews. That works for most guests. For the 5-10% of bookings that cause real damage, it does not. This module gives you the screening framework that turns a "trust the platform" stance into "trust the platform and verify the high-value bookings".

Who to screen

Not every booking needs screening. Screen the bookings where a bad outcome would hurt you most:

- Stays of 4+ nights (the most common duration for party houses)
- Bookings from accounts with fewer than 2 verified reviews
- Bookings requested for dates within 14 days of arrival (low-lead-time bookings correlate with party bookings)
- Bookings with 6+ guests where the property sleeps 4-6 (watch the headcount, even if the platform doesn't)
- Bookings from outside the country where the property is located (statistical correlation with damage, even when profile looks clean)

The pre-approval message script

Sending this when a high-risk inquiry lands takes 90 seconds and converts either into a safe booking or into a self-cancel. Don't use it as a stalking tactic. Use it as a verification step.

Hi [guest name], thanks for your interest in [property name]! Quick few things so I can confirm you and the property are a good fit:

1. What's the occasion for the trip? (Weddings, birthdays, graduations, etc. — these are not red flags by themselves, but context matters.)
2. How many adults and children will be staying? (Matches what you saw in the booking request.)
3. Have you stayed at a [cabin / urban / etc.] property before? (Optional. New guests are not red flags, but experienced guests tend to treat properties better.)
4. Anything about the property you want to confirm before booking? (Lets them flag unusual needs early — pool heat, parking, pet policy, early check-in.)

Once I have those answers, I'll send a confirmation and we can lock in the dates. Looking forward to hosting you.

How to interpret the answers

Most inquiries respond cleanly within a few hours. Patterns to watch:

- Hesitation to answer any of the four questions = mismatch in expectations
- Headcount on the request doesn't match what they say = misrepresentation; decline and refund
- Aspirational language ("small gathering", "intimate celebration", "quiet birthday") with 8+ guests = high party risk, decline
- Local addresses with short lead-time for weekend stays = sometimes a last-minute party request; ask questions, consider declining

Declining a booking gracefully

If you decide to decline, do it within 24 hours, be polite, refund any platform fees you collected, and offer a reason that's true but doesn't punish the guest (e.g., "the property is not a match for the timing" rather than "I don't trust you"). The platform keeps your decline history. Excessive declines hurt your listing's algorithmic visibility.

If you have a record of declining high-risk bookings, the platform sends you fewer of them. Decline responsibly and you will protect both the property and your own conversion rate over time.

Module 06 — Done. Module 07 covers dynamic pricing — how to set nightly rates that lift revenue without pricing yourself out.

Dynamic Pricing: Lift Revenue Without Pricing Yourself Out

Pricing is a 10-minute-per-day activity that, done well, is the largest single revenue driver for a managed listing. Done poorly, it either leaves money on the table or prices you out of bookings and tanks your review velocity. This module gives you the framework we use across our managed portfolio.

The base price: your starting point

Your base price is the nightly rate you charge when nothing unusual is happening — a Tuesday in February, a Monday in May, a Sunday in October. It should be set by the comp set, not by your gut.

Pull three comparable properties within 5 miles. Same bedroom count, similar amenities (hot tub, pool, fireplace, view, etc.). Note their base price for a weeknight and a weekend night. Set your base price at the median, not the average — the median is what the market actually books against.

Re-pull the comp set every 30 days. As new comps enter or leave the market, your base price shifts. A base price set in March might be 8% out of market by July.

The adjustments: day-of-week, season, lead time

Once your base price is set, you adjust up or down for four variables:

Day of week. Friday and Saturday in most markets carry a 15-30% uplift over the base. Three-night minimums on weekends lock in revenue.

Seasonality. Holiday weekends, school breaks, and local events drive 50-200% uplifts. Build a season calendar before the year starts, then update it as new events are confirmed.

Lead time. Last-minute bookings (under 14 days) typically warrant a discount — same-day can be 30% off. Bookings 60+ days out are typically worth slight premium pricing.

Occupancy. If your calendar is empty 30 days out, lower your price 5-10% across the gap. If you are 80% booked 30 days out, raise the gap 5%.

The pricing software decision

Tools like PriceLabs, Wheelhouse, and Beyond Pricing automate the day-to-day. If you are managing 3+ properties, one of these tools pays for itself within the first month. For 1-2 properties, the cost-benefit is closer to break-even — manual daily pricing is fine if you have the discipline.

Either way, you should still review the recommended price once a week and override when you know something the algorithm doesn't (a major local event, a known construction project down the road). The tool augments your judgment; it does not replace it.

The minimum-night, maximum-night rules

Your minimum-night setting is also a pricing lever. A 2-night minimum captures weekend-only stays that a 3-night minimum would lose. A 4-night minimum pushes mid-week bookings off your calendar.

Default for most urban and cabin properties: 2-night minimum on weekdays, 3-night minimum on weekends. Lifted to 4-7 nights around holidays when every night is bookable.

The cleaning fee decision

Cleaning fees should cover your actual turnover clean cost plus a small margin. Keep them visible — guests filter on cleaning fee as much as on nightly rate. A \$200 cleaning fee on a \$150/night property is a deal-breaker; the same fee on a \$400/night property is fine.

Module 07 — Done. Module 08 covers the monthly statement — the deliverable that keeps owners renewing.

MODULE 08

The Monthly Owner Statement: Keep Owners Renewing

The single biggest reason cohost engagements end: the owner didn't feel in control. The monthly statement is how you fix that. Done well, it is the document that makes the owner say, "I am glad I hired them" every single month.

What goes in the statement

A clean monthly statement has these blocks, in this order, totaling one page:

- **Cover line.** "Here is the [Month] statement for [Property]. Net payout to you: \$[X]. [One sentence about what happened.] "
- **Revenue breakdown.** Gross bookings, platform fees (Airbnb service fee, cleaning fee kept), net to host. By booking if there were multiple.
- **Expenses pass-through.** Cleaning (number of turns), supplies, maintenance calls, vendor payments. Each line item with vendor and amount.
- **Cohost fee.** The fee you earned under the contract. Visible. Never buried.
- **Net payout.** The line the owner cares about. Bold, large, at the bottom.
- **This month vs last month.** Revenue, occupancy rate, average nightly rate. Side by side. Optional YoY.
- **Coming up.** Anything they should know about next month: a local event, a planned maintenance window, a refi or sale if they mentioned one.
- **Open actions.** Anything the owner needs to do: approve a vendor invoice, sign a renewal, confirm a booking.

When to send it

By the 5th of the following month, every month. If you cannot hit the 5th, communicate early. Silence until the 8th is the second biggest reason owners leave.

If the property had zero bookings in the month, send the statement anyway. An empty statement that arrives on time is more reassuring than silence.

The quarterly review

Every quarter, schedule a 30-minute call to walk the owner through the trailing three months. Topics:

- Trend in revenue, occupancy, ADR vs. market comps
- Maintenance issues that came up; are any of them structural (capital expense the owner should know about)
- Pricing experiments from the quarter: what we tried, what worked
- Operational SOPs we updated this quarter and why
- Forward-looking opportunities (additional nights, new platforms, off-season marketing)

Module 08 — Done. Module 09 covers owner outreach — how to find your first 3-5 owners to cohost for.

MODULE 09

Owner Outreach: Finding Your First 5

The most expensive activity for a new cohost is finding the first 5 owners to manage for. Once you have 5, referrals do most of the work. Until you have 5, you are doing sales. This module covers the three outreach channels that have worked for us, in priority order.

Channel 1: Airbnb / VRBO listing-mining

The fastest path to your first 3 owners. Identify 50-100 listings in your city that match your niche (cabin, urban, etc.), have review scores below 4.7 (red flag for the owner), and have stale calendars (sign of neglect, owner might be overwhelmed).

Send a polite, low-friction first email. Reference a specific thing you noticed about the listing ("your calendar shows you opened the Spring 2026 dates late last year — that's costing you X in lost bookings"). Offer a free 15-minute audit, not a sales call.

Channel 2: Local real-estate networks

Real estate agents, property managers, and HOA managers see owner-overwhelmed situations every week. They are not your competitors; they are your distribution channel. Most agents will happily refer an overwhelmed investor to a competent cohost.

Build a one-pager they can hand to a frustrated owner: "If your Airbnb isn't performing, here is who to call." Give 10-15 agents the one-pager. Referral flow starts in 30-60 days.

Channel 3: Furnished Finder + remote-owner circles

If you serve the mid-term (30+ night) market, Furnished Finder is the primary surface where remote owners look for help. Active posts, DM conversations, and a strong profile there will compound over time.

Facebook groups for "remote Airbnb owners", "STR investing", and specific city/AirBnB groups are also sources. Engagement first, sales second.

The outreach email template (channel 1)

Subject: Quick observation about [Property Name]

Body:

Hi [owner name],

I'm [your name], a cohost in [city]. I came across your listing at [address] while reviewing the [cabin / urban / etc.] market for a client.

I noticed two patterns that often cost owners in your market \$X/year:

1. [Specific observation — calendar stale, photo count low, etc.]
2. [Second specific observation]

I don't have anything to sell. I'm offering a free 15-minute audit if you're curious whether this is fixable. Reply with a time that works and I'll send a calendar link.

[Your name]

[Phone if comfortable] · [LinkedIn if kept current]

The follow-up cadence

If no reply: one follow-up at 7 days, then stop. Persistent follow-ups flag you as spam. Move on to the next listing.

If they book the audit: deliver within 48 hours (see Module 05).

If they decline: ask for the reason, log it. Most will tell you. The patterns across declines tell you what your positioning is missing.

Module 09 — Done. Module 10 covers scaling — what changes when you go from 1 property to 5 to 15.

MODULE 10

Scaling: From 1 Property to 5 to 15

The first 3 properties teach you the work. Properties 4-9 teach you the systems. Properties 10-15 teach you the business. This module covers the inflection points and what changes at each one.

Properties 1-3: Do the work yourself

You are doing every message, every pricing update, every cleaning coordination yourself. This is the only way to learn what good looks like. Build your SOPs in real time, document them in Notion or a shared doc.

Time per property: 18-25 hours/week. Don't take a fourth property until your time per property is consistently below 12 hours/week.

Properties 4-9: Systematize

Hire your first cleaner. Build a cleaning checklist and a turnover workflow. Hire your first part-time helper or VA for guest communications. Document everything they need to read.

Two products at this stage — you have a cohosting practice (the work) and a cohosting business (the systems + the team + the leverage). The business is what scales; the practice is what pays you today.

Time per property with one helper: 8-12 hours/week.

Properties 10-15: Hire and delegate

Hire a second cleaner or a small cleaning team. Hire your first full-time assistant (operations coordinator). Train them on every SOP you have written. Their job is to run the SOPs, not to make decisions — decisions stay with you.

At 15 properties you are probably ready to hire a managing cohost (someone with a track record who can own 5-7 properties end-to-end under your brand). Your role shifts: account management, owner relationships, business development, pricing strategy.

Time per property with a coordinator + a managing cohost: 3-5 hours/week.

The mistake that kills most cohosting practices

Scaling too fast. Taking properties 5 and 6 before you have actually systematized properties 3 and 4. The result: every new property is more work, not less, and service quality collapses. Renewal rates drop. Referrals dry up. You burn out within 12-18 months and shut it down.

The discipline is: only take a new property when your existing portfolio is running at the time target for that scale (18h at 1-3, 10h at 4-9, 4h at 10-15). If you are not hitting the target, you are not ready to scale. Fix the systems first.

What comes after 15 properties

Two paths. You become a cohosting agency (a real entity with a brand, multiple operators, a sales pipeline, and a target of 30-100 properties). Or you stay as a high-touch solo operator with 12-15 properties at premium pricing. Both are real businesses. Most cohosts who hit 15 chose one within 90 days — usually whichever path better matches the energy they get from the work.

The Cohosting Startup Kit ends here.

If you made it through all 10 modules, you have the operating reference for a real cohosting practice: the operating definition, positioning, contracts, pricing, listing audit, guest screening, dynamic pricing, monthly statements, owner outreach, and the scaling path.

What you do with it is up to you. The 6-week Mentorship cohort at \$1,000 covers the parts this kit does not — live case review, your specific market, your specific challenges. If this kit raised as many questions as it answered, that is the right next step.